SUNY Old Westbury 2026-2027 Undergraduate Catalog

Multicultural U.S./ British Literature, Minor

Sponsoring department: English

The Multicultural U.S./British Literature minor includes texts from the U.S. and U.K. by writers of different ethnicities, genders, sexualities, classes, and ability/disability status. It focuses on the complexity of two countries in which people of many different cultures cohabit. It provides grounding in recent debates in literary study and features intensive work in effective writing and expression. Majors in Media and Communication, Business programs, and other areas will benefit from this minor, which improves communication skills that are fundamental to teaching, writing, and speaking.

Program of Study

The minor requires five courses (20 credits) drawn from the first four tiers of the English degree (Multicultural U.S./British Literature Concentration) culminating with Major Authors, an in-depth look at the life and work of one or more authors.

Requirements

(Select one from each group)

A. Linguistic Foundations: 4 Credits

- EL 3010 - Structure and Grammar of English Credits: 4

B. Literary Analysis: 4 Credits

- EL 3500 - Literature Across Cultures I: Analysis Credits: 4
- EL 3510 - Literature Across Cultures II: Theory Credits: 4
- EL 4400 - Critical Theory Credits: 4

C. Literary Traditions: 4 Credits

- EL 3600 - U.S. Literature I-Colonial Period to Civil War Credits: 4
- EL 3610 - U.S. Literature II-Civil War to the Present Credits: 4
- EL 3800 - English Literature I: Beowulf to 18th Century, inclusive of Shakespeare Credits: 4
- EL 3810 - English Literature II: Romantics to Present Credits: 4

- EL 3950 - Creative Non-Fiction Credits: 4
- EL 4200 - Biblical/Classical Influences on Multicultural Literature Credits: 4
- EL 4300 - Twentieth-Century Literature: Colonialism and Post Colonialism Credits: 4
- EL 4325 - Shakespeare: Selected Plays Credits: 4
- EL 4500 - Topics in British/U.S. Literature Credits: 4
- EL 4510 - Modern Drama and Theater Credits: 4
- EL 4520 - Reading and Writing the Short Story Credits: 4

D. Perspectives on Literature: 4 Credits

(choose ONE course from any group)

British/U.S. Literature

- EL 4030 - Women and Narrative Credits: 4
- EL 4050 - Lesbian and Gay Literature Credits: 4
- EL 4060 - Literature of Class and Class Consciousness Credits: 4
- EL 4080 - Extraordinary Bodies: Disability in Literature Credits: 4

U.S. Literature

- ML 3410 - Latino/a Writers in the United States Credits: 4
- EL 3811 - Survey of African American Literature
- EL 4000 - Native American Literature Credits: 4
- EL 4010 - The Harlem Renaissance Credits: 4
- EL 4015 - Multi-Ethnic Literatures of the United States Credits: 4
- EL 4020 - Asian American Literature Credits: 4
- EL 4040 - Black Women Writers Credits: 4
- EL 4070 - Topics in African American Literature Credits: 4
- EL 4090 - The Afro-American Novel Credits: 4
- EL 4091 - Afro-American Poetry and Plays Credits: 4
- EL 4405 - Caribbean Literature Credits: 4

British Literature

- EL 4550 - Modern British Literature 1890 - 1960 Credits: 4
- EL 4560 - Multicultural British Literature since 1960 Credits: 4

E. Major Literary Figures: 4 Credits

- EL 4800 - Major Authors Credits: 4